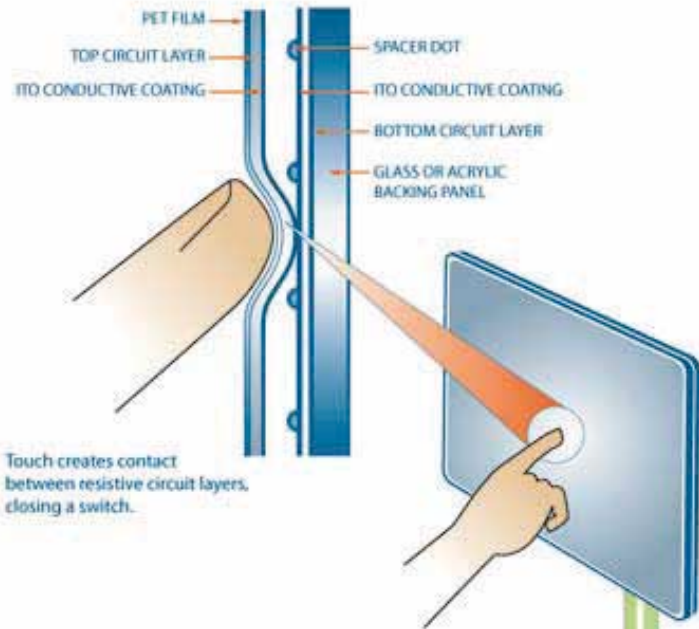




The principle behind the working of a capacitive touchscreen

it could only detect one touch at a time, eliminating the possibility of a multi-touch display. Resistive touchscreens were less responsible in general.

Most modern touchscreen devices employ a technology called ‘Capacitive Touch’ which rectified many of the shortcomings of stylus-based resistive touchscreens. Steve Jobs famously remarked, “Who needs a stylus? God gave us 10 styluses—let’s not invent another” and vehemently refused to include a stylus of any kind in his iconic products – the iPhone and the iPad. As the name suggests, capacitive touchscreens use the principle of a capacitor to register interactions with the device. A thin layer of conducting material rests below an insulating glass piece. The conducting layer carries a current of constant magnitude and frequency. When another conducting, current carrying device (such as the human finger, which carries a small amount of current) comes in contact with the screen, it creates a change in the current in the circuit due to charge build up near the finger. This change in current is registered by the device, which helps in tracking the exact location of the touch. Capacitive touch screens have several advantages over their resistive counterparts. They are longer lasting, more